

₹18,500), pouring in from Louis Vuitton's HNI client base.

Anand, arguably the most well-known Indian chef in the world, is no stranger to running high-profile or booked-out restaurants. With two Michelin stars to his credit and a four-year stint atop the Asia's 50 Best Restaurants list, his culinary journey has been well-documented, including an episode on Netflix's *Chef's Table*, which earned an Emmy nomination.

But this collaboration with LV is unlike anything he has done before. Every aspect of the restaurant, from its decor to its tableware, has undergone meticulous scrutiny and approval from the LVMH headquarters in Paris. LV's iconic motifs grace everything from plates and glasses to staff uniforms, even manifesting in the form of embossed ice cubes. Meanwhile, the chef, known for his quirky fashion sense, has undergone a noticeable transformation, appearing trimmer and clad in a bespoke "greige" ensemble crafted by the fashion house, perfectly complementing the restaurant's upscale ambiance.

What truly sets this collaboration apart is its sheer audacity. The menu showcases Anand's signature dishes, now presented with a dash of LV flair. From the "Yoghurt Explosion" delicately perched on a base shaped like the brand's monogram to the "Damier Momo," a mushroom dumpling adorned with the iconic Damier print, each creation is a testament to the fusion of cuisine and couture. However, in classic Anand style, there's a playful twist; with creations like the "Patrani Macchi" wrapped in an LV-embossed banana leaf, theatrically torched table-side setting the brand logo ablaze, and "Lick It Up," a dish



served without cutlery, compelling diners to pick up and lick their plates clean. While Anand's unorthodox culinary style may seem at odds with LV's conservative heritage, it is precisely this amalgamation of contrasting cultures that breathes an electrifying vitality into the restaurant.

But why did LV opt to collaborate with Anand? Part of the rationale lies in LV's recent penchant for unconventional partnerships, spanning trendy streetwear labels like Supreme and eccentric artists like Yayoi Kusama and Takashi Murakami, alongside their choice of new-age Creative Directors like Pharrell Williams and the late Virgil Abloh. Additionally, there's an acknowledgment that food holds a certain allure. Chefs are the new icons and aligning with their persona allows fashion brands to resonate with diverse demographics and entice potential consumers.



The Gucci Osteria restaurant in Seoul (top), a collaboration between Gucci and chef Massimo Bottura